

The Most Popular Security Assessment and Server Hardening Tools

Enterprises require high levels of security for their computer systems. A server attack or a malware intrusion can cause incalculable damage. Prudence, therefore, is the keyword here. This article describes the most popular server auditing and testing tools, along with penetration testing and network security tools.



Most enterprises tend to provide Web services to their customers as an Internet presence is important due to factors like the high revenue-generation potential, exposure to a wide range of customers, etc. This fact makes enterprise services susceptible to various Web application related attacks like cross site scripting, SQL injections, buffer overflows, etc, as well as attacks over the network like distributed denial-of-service (DDoS), malware intrusion, sniffing, etc.

Security is one of the most important aspects when it comes to building large scale IT enterprises. There is an extensive collection of tools that deal with various security threats and make systems less vulnerable to them. This article aims at describing a few popular tools that are aimed at enhancing the security of servers in a data centre environment.

Server auditing and hardening tools

Bastille

This is an interactive system-hardening open source program. It bundles a variety of system-hardening options into a single easy-to-use package. Bastille can be employed to harden a number of platforms and distributions including Red Hat and Red Hat Enterprise, SUSE, Mandriva, Gentoo, Fedora Core, Debian and TurboLinux. It is also supported on HP-UX and, in beta, on OS X. It is a collection of PERL scripts that create a custom security configuration based on the answers provided by the administrator to a specific set of questions. It also does an in-depth analysis of the system's current hardening level and its various security loopholes, thereby decreasing the